



every possible tool imaginable for recording, editing and mastering your audio. From trimming clips to reshaping sounds with a single click, Pro Tools truly has it all. It also has something called a Smart Tool which intuitively changes editing tools based on your cursor position, eliminating the need to manually switch tools. It can also fix timing and the pitch of your audio and easily compile multiple recordings into one. Subscription starts at \$29.99.

Audacity

Audacity is a free cross-platform audio editor that is commonly-used for podcasting due to its array of powerful features. The software has a bit of a learning curve attached to it, however, once you get the hang of it, there are multiple tools that can help users elevate the quality of their podcasts. Some of the useful features

include SyncLock, Truncate Silence, and Silence Finder. You also have features such as a savable EQ, audio fading, several import and export options, and others.

Alitu

Alitu is an audio editing software with an easy-to-use interface that makes editing podcasts a breeze. All you need to do is drag and drop recordings to the right slots, add your music, add fading, and you're done. It also integrates directly with Podcast.co, so you can directly publish episodes straight to all podcast directories with one single click. Users get a 7-day free trial run after which the standard subscription costs \$28 or \$19 per month.

Descript

Leveraging the power of AI, Descript attempts to make the podcast editing process as seamless as possible.

The software allows you to edit an audio file as if it were a word document. It turns your audio into text, broken up into segments by who's speaking, and then you can manipulate these audio files that are essentially all text. You can delete a sentence or two, or even a paragraph. Descript also automatically shortens the files to remove unwanted blank spaces and make the recording sound natural. The standard subscription costs \$10 per month.

are some of the best for noise reduction. RX Denoiser comes loaded with extra tools while SoundSoap is a simple denoise-only plugin that gets the job done easily.

- **iZotope Ozone** - If you are looking for compression with some extra bells and whistles, iZotope Ozone is a great option. In addition to usual compression features, it also comes equipped with a multi-band compressor



DON'T SHY AWAY FROM PLUGINS

There are countless plugins that can help elevate the quality of your podcast. These plugins help you fix recording issues of varying severity and help you attain a clear-sounding final product that is pleasant to the listener's ears. Most audio editing software already come equipped with a wide variety of plugins. However, if your software has something missing, you can take a look at external plugins.

- **SoundSoap and RX Denoiser** - These plugins

- **Waves L1 and Sonic Anomaly's Unlimited** - Limiters are a hit or miss in audio editing software, since many don't include it. Some external options that stand out in terms of functionality include the Waves L1 and Sonic Anomaly's Unlimited.
- **iZotope Ozone** - If you need to purchase an equaliser separately, then you should look into iZotope Ozone yet again. It comes equipped with an 8-band EQ that also comes with EQ matching and other elements. 

